

The Clever Fox and the Forest Fix

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



Part 1: The Broken Wheel

Once upon a time, in a sunny forest, there lived a clever little fox named Finley. Finley loved to explore. Every day was a new adventure. One bright morning, Finley decided to visit his friend, Bella the bunny. He hopped onto his trusty red wagon, ready to roll down the leafy paths.

But oh no! As Finley started his journey, he heard a clunk. He stopped and looked. One of the wheels on his wagon was wobbly and loose. « **Oh dear,** » said Finley, scratching his head. « **I need my wagon to visit Bella. How can I fix this?** »

Finley decided to be brave and smart. He knew he needed to fix the wheel. So, he scampered into the forest, hoping to find something to help. « **Maybe I can find a stick or a stone,** » he thought. As he walked, the birds chirped cheerfully, and the sun peeked through the trees.

Finley found a shiny pebble. « **This might help!** » he said, picking it up. He tried to fit it into the wheel, but it was too small. « **Hmm,** » Finley pondered. « **I need something bigger.** »

Part 2: The Forest Friends

Finley continued his journey. Soon, he met Charlie the chipmunk. « **Hello, Finley!** » chirped Charlie. « **What are you doing?** »

« **My wagon is broken,** » said Finley. « **I need to fix the wheel.** »

Charlie thought for a moment. « **I have some nuts! Maybe one could work!** » he suggested. Charlie gave Finley a big acorn. Finley tried it, but it didn't fit either.

« **Thank you, Charlie,** » said Finley, smiling. « **I'll keep looking.** »

Finley trotted along and saw Lily the squirrel. « **Hi, Finley!** » squeaked Lily. « **Why do you look so puzzled?** »

Finley explained his problem. « **I need to fix my wagon to visit Bella.** »

Lily had an idea. « **I found a round button yesterday! It might fit.** » She handed the button to Finley. Finley tried it, but it was too big.

« **Thank you, Lily,** » said Finley kindly. « **I'll keep searching.** »

Part 3: The Perfect Fit

As Finley walked on, he felt a little tired but didn't give up. He knew he needed to think smart. Just then, he saw Sammy the hedgehog rolling a round piece of bark.

« **Hi, Sammy!** » called Finley. « **What do you have there?** »

Sammy stopped and showed Finley the bark. « **I found this today. It's round and smooth.** »

Finley's eyes twinkled. « **May I try it on my wagon?** » he asked.

« **Of course!** » said Sammy, smiling.

Finley carefully placed the bark next to the wheel. It fit perfectly! The wheel was steady again. « **Hooray!** » cheered Finley. « **Thank you, Sammy!** »

With his wagon fixed, Finley was ready to go. He waved goodbye to his friends and rolled happily through the forest. The day was bright, and Finley felt proud. He had used his cleverness and his friends' help to solve the problem.

Finally, Finley reached Bella's burrow. « **Hello, Bella!** » he called, wagging his

tail.

« **Hi, Finley!** » Bella replied. « **I'm so glad you came.** »

Together, they played and laughed, enjoying their sunny day. Finley felt happy knowing he could always count on his friends and his own clever mind. And from that day on, every adventure was filled with joy, courage, and smiles.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the little fox in the story?

- Finley the fox
- Bella the bunny
- Charlie the chipmunk
- Lily the squirrel

2) What was broken on Finley's wagon?

- The wheel
- The door
- The hat
- The tree

3) Who gave the round piece of bark that fixed the wagon?

- Sammy the hedgehog
- Bella the bunny
- Lily the squirrel
- Charlie the chipmunk

4) Where did Finley go to visit his friend?

- Bella's burrow
- The river
- The mountain
- The shop

Correct answers:

1) *Finley the fox* 2) *The wheel* 3) *Sammy the hedgehog* 4) *Bella's burrow*

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Clever: Smart and quick at thinking of good ideas or solutions.

Explore: To go around and look at new places and things.

Adventure: A fun or exciting trip where something new can happen.

Leafy: Full of leaves, like trees with many green leaves.

Wobbly: Shaky and not steady, moving from side to side.

Scratching: Rubbing skin or head with a hand or paw gently.

Scampered: Ran quickly and happily with small fast steps.

Shiny pebble: A small, smooth rock that looks bright and clean.

Pondered: Thought about something slowly and carefully.

Acorn: A small brown nut from an oak tree that animals eat.

Trotted: Moved with quick, steady steps, like a little run.

Squeaked: Made a short, high sound, like a small voice.

Kindly: Being nice and helpful with gentle words or actions.

Carefully: Doing something slowly and with attention to safety.

Steady: Firm and not moving or falling, held in place.

Burrow: A small hole or tunnel in the ground where animals live.

Wagging: Moving a tail back and forth when happy or excited.

Cleverness: The ability to think of smart and useful ideas.